

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



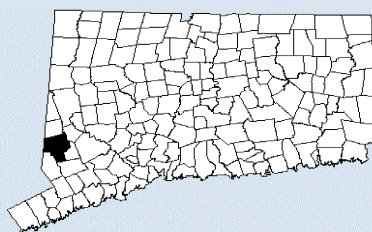
Danbury School District

Kevin Walston, Superintendent • 203-797-4701 • www.danbury.k12.ct.us/

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	21
Enrollment	12,126
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$16,742
Total Expenditures ¹	\$203,718,659

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	6,283	51.8	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	543	4.5	5.2
Black or African American	779	6.4	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	7,776	64.1	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	463	3.8	4.7
White	2,538	20.9	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	4,364	36.0	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	6,350	52.4	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	1,763	14.5	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	343	5.5
Male	1,118	18.1	749	11.2
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	138	18.3	117	14.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,355	17.4	766	9.1
White	357	14.6	158	6.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	804	17.4	429	8.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,325	19.7	761	9.8
Students with Disabilities	394	24.6	225	11.3
District	2,025	16.9	1,092	8.5
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 2,524

Number of school-based arrests: 28

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Danbury School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	750.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	64.2
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	111.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	181.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	20.4
School Level	50.6
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	18.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	46.3
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	69.0
School Nurses	30.6
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	473.3

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	2	0.2	0.1
Asian	24	2.3	1.4
Black or African American	49	4.6	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	94	8.8	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	2	0.2	0.3
White	898	84.0	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	12.9	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	60	96.8	64	100.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	503	92.8	464	94.9
White	200	99.0	236	99.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	225	86.5	171	89.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	464	95.9	408	98.3
Students with Disabilities	108	97.3	136	96.5
District	840	94.6	826	96.6
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	55	26.2
Emotional Disability	10	23.8
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	431	77.1
Other Health Impairment	141	66.5
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	235	69.7
District	882	59.6
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Danbury School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	219	1.8	2.6
Emotional Disability	42	0.4	1.1
Intellectual Disability	68	0.6	0.6
Learning Disability	563	4.7	6.4
Other Health Impairment	214	1.8	3.5
Other Disabilities	150	1.3	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	385	3.2	2.0
All Disabilities	1,641	13.8	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	17	1.0	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	72	4.4	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$147,802,666	\$12,147	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$4,839,255	\$400	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$3,025,458	\$250	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$2,762,864	\$229	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$3,963,328	\$328	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$10,006,710	\$828	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$15,785,924	\$1,306	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$12,112,514	\$1,352	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$3,419,940	\$283	\$213
Total	\$203,718,659	\$16,742	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$10,159,210	25.2	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$3,130,930	7.8	10.2
Other Salaries	\$9,575,732	23.8	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$5,323,259	13.2	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,381,995	3.4	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$4,661,497	11.6	22.2
Supplies	\$297,024	0.7	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$5,056,241	12.5	8.4
Equipment	\$726,756	1.8	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$40,312,644	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		19.8	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	59.4
State	25.6
Federal	14.6
Tuition & Other	0.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Danbury School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	273	69.8	273	67.3	119	66.1
Black or African American	365	54.5	365	47.7	177	51.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	3,590	51.6	3,588	48.6	1,510	48.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Two or More Races	199	60.4	198	55.3	*	*
White	1,270	62.7	1,269	57.9	609	62.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	2,542	48.6	2,539	46.4	982	45.0
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	3,165	60.9	3,164	56.1	1,522	58.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	3,294	51.7	3,291	47.8	1,398	49.5
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,413	60.4	2,412	57.2	1,106	58.2
Students with Disabilities	816	38.5	812	34.3	342	36.4
Students without Disabilities	4,891	58.2	4,891	54.7	2,162	56.0
High Needs	4,273	50.9	4,269	47.6	1,796	48.5
Non-High Needs	1,434	68.7	1,434	64.3	708	65.7
District	5,707	55.4	5,703	51.8	2,504	53.3

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	93.3	81.2	80.8	84.1	3,493	84.7
Curl Up	86.5	80.1	77.4	94.3	3,480	84.5
Push Up	79.3	77.4	72.2	71.2	3,465	75.0
Mile Run/PACER	82.2	71.5	54.3	65.0	3,470	68.0
All Tests - District	63.6	52.2	41.6	49.7	3,424	51.6
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Danbury School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	65	81.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	401	72.6
White	255	83.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	101	47.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	514	73.5
Students with Disabilities	134	59.7
District	798	77.9
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	220	26.6
Male	185	20.2
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	14	11.1
Hispanic or Latino	156	15.1
White	168	38.2
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	27	6.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	151	16.8
Students with Disabilities	6	2.4
District	405	23.2
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	68.3	86.0
Male	53.6	80.7
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	63.8	89.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	53.7	79.9
White	69.0	84.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	23.6	71.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	57.3	79.6
Students with Disabilities	42.7	63.8
District	61.5	83.6
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Danbury School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	55.4	75	36.9	50	73.9	63.9
	High Needs Students	50.9	75	34.0	50	67.9	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	51.8	75	34.5	50	69.0	60.2
	High Needs Students	47.6	75	31.7	50	63.4	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	53.3	75	35.6	50	71.1	61.8
	High Needs Students	48.5	75	32.3	50	64.6	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	52.5%	100%	52.5	100	52.5	58.7%
	High Needs Students	51.5%	100%	51.5	100	51.5	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	52.7%	100%	52.7	100	52.7	61.4%
	High Needs Students	51.4%	100%	51.4	100	51.4	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	62.0%	100%	31.0	50	62.0	58.9%
	Oral	58.5%	100%	29.2	50	58.5	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	16.9%	<=5%	26.2	50	52.4	17.7%
	High Needs Students	19.1%	<=5%	21.7	50	43.5	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	95.6%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	23.2%	75%	15.5	50	31.0	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		70.1%	94%	37.3	50	74.6	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		77.9%	94%	82.9	100	82.9	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		85.3%	94%	90.8	100	90.8	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		61.5%	75%	82.0	100	82.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		92.7% 51.6%	75%	34.4	50	68.8	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		54.4%	60%	45.3	50	90.7	55.0%
Accountability Index				959.6	1450	66.2	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	68.7	50.9	17.7	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	64.3	47.6	16.7	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	65.7	48.5	17.2	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	85.3%	8.7%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.4
	High Needs Students	99.3
Math	All Students	99.4
	High Needs Students	99.3
Science	All Students	99.2
	High Needs Students	99.1

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 44.1

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Danbury School District

Narratives

Danbury Public School's rich diversity has enabled us to develop and enhance awareness of the cultural, racial, ethnic, and socio-economic backgrounds of our students and families.

We work to ensure that our diversity is reflected in our curricula, teaching strategies, and choice of materials. We have a K-5 magnet school, a 6-8 lottery school, and a 9-12 dual enrollment program to provide choice for parents and students at the elementary, middle, and school levels. All students eventually come together when they attend Danbury High School.

Danbury has secured a site and funding for its Career Academy opening in 2025 that will provide students with workforce pathways opportunities to become job ready alongside becoming collagen ready.

The district communications team to enhance two-way communication through enhanced web presence, social media, and other modalities to keep families and the community informed about work in the school district.

Through a rigorous academic program and recently approved Portrait of Graduate, we encourage students to be Advocates, Collaborators, Innovators, and Learners who purposely Communicate their thinking and act as global stewards.

Each school supports and works to help every student to recognize and advance to their full potential. The diversity within our district is one of our strengths. We embrace that and have made it our goal to motivate, inspire, and empower each member of our diverse learning community.

In order to effectively communicate with families, notices are sent home in a variety of languages to ensure families are able to have a voice in their child's education. The district provides interpreters to schools for parent engagement events and uses interpreting devices to address language barriers where appropriate.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Danbury School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Danbury Public Schools is committed to ensuring equity. This commitment is visible across all areas of our work, strategic plan and funding of district, school, and program improvement.

Danbury Public Schools makes resources available at each school to accomplish this goal. The annual operating budgets are thoughtfully developed each year based on the known and anticipated needs for the current school year.

In order to support district and school improvement, supplemental grants are directly allocated to the schools with the most needs.

We staff at appropriate levels to support students who need additional services and resources (ELLs, students with disabilities, etc.). In order to ensure that there is equity of resources across the district, we use a consistent class size enrollment to determine the number of teachers, specialists, coaches, support personnel, and staff needed.

As construction on the new Danbury Career Academy begin, we are also improving Danbury High School to ensure students who remain at the east side campus have access to the same innovative, state of the art facilities as students attending the new building.